GRC 10ALYTICS JUNE 2026 COHORT

ASSIGNMENT

BUSINESS CONTINUITY, DISASTER RECOVERY & CRISIS MANAGEMENT: COASTAL UNION BANK

NAME: MOYINOLUWA AREGBESOLA

INSTRUCTOR: VICTORIA OLUYORI

CRISIS COMMUNICATION PLAN

Customer communication message

Subject: Temporary Disruption to Banking Services

Dear Valued Customer,

We are currently experiencing a technical issue affecting our core banking system. This may cause temporary delays or interruptions to some banking services, including transactions and online banking.

Our IT team is working urgently to restore services and minimize the disruption. We apologize for the inconvenience and appreciate your patience. We will provide another update through our official communication channels by 11:00am. For assistance, please contact our customer support team.

Thank you for your understanding.

Coastal Union Bank

Crisis activation path

The **COO** is responsible for declaring a crisis based on the Incident Commander's assessment of the outage and its impact on banking operations. If the COO is unavailable, the CEO assumes this responsibility. Once a crisis is declared:

1. The Incident Commander notifies the COO and recommends activating the Crisis Management Team (CMT).
2. The COO authorizes activation of the CMT.
3. The Incident Commander or designated coordinator contacts team members through the emergency contact list, using phone calls or approved emergency communication channels.
4. The CMT meets immediately, virtually or in person, to coordinate recovery priorities, operational continuity, and communication.
5. The Communications Lead issues approved updates, while the IT and Operations Leads provide regular recovery progress reports.

Key CMT Responsibilities

- **Incident Commander:** Leads and coordinates the crisis response.
- **IT Recovery Lead:** Investigates the outage and restores banking systems.
- **Operations Lead:** Coordinates business continuity arrangements.
- **Risk and Legal Lead:** Advises on regulatory and legal obligations.
- **Communications Lead:** Manages approved customer, employee, and public updates.
- **Business Recovery Leads:** Coordinate affected departments, report operational impacts.

TABLETOP EXERCISE SCENARIO

Exercise Title: Core Banking System Outage

Objective: To assess Coastal Union Bank's ability to activate its crisis management structure, coordinate recovery activities, maintain essential banking services, and communicate with customers during a major system outage.

Initial Scenario

At 8:30a.m on Monday, Coastal Union Bank's IT team receives reports that its core banking system, hosted at the primary data centre, is unavailable. Several branches cannot access customer account information or process transactions. Mobile and online banking services are also affected. The IT team begins investigating but cannot immediately identify the cause or estimate the recovery time. Customer complaints begin increasing. The Incident Commander informs the COO and recommends declaring a crisis and activating the CMT.

Escalation Inject 1: Payment Processing Disruption

At 10:00a.m, the IT team confirms that payment processing is also affected. Several customer transactions are delayed, and important payment and settlement deadlines are approaching. The recovery team estimates that restoring the system may take several more hours.

Discussion Questions:

- How should the CMT prioritize recovery of critical banking services?
- What alternative arrangements can support urgent transactions?
- How should affected customers and payment partners be informed?

Escalation Inject 2: Customer and Reputational Impact

At 12:00p.m, the outage remains unresolved. Customer complaints increase on social media and a local news outlet contacts the bank for an explanation. Customer support is overwhelmed and customers are concerned about the safety of their funds. The cause and recovery time remain unconfirmed.

Discussion Questions:

- Who approves the bank's public response?
- How should the bank communicate without speculating about the cause?
- How will customer support manage the increased demand?
- How frequently should the CMT provide updates?

Expected Outcomes

The exercise should help the bank assess whether it can:

- Activate the CMT promptly and assign clear responsibilities.
- Prioritize critical banking services and coordinate recovery.

- Maintain communication with customers and stakeholders.
- Manage reputational and operational risks during an outage.
- Identify weaknesses and document corrective actions for improving the Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery plans.